



— A VISITOR'S GUIDE · SOUFRIÈRE-SCOTT'S HEAD MARINE RESERVE

SOUFRIÈRE & SCOTT'S HEAD

A guide to Dominica's most spectacular corner — where to stay, where to eat, and how to spend your days where the volcano meets the sea.

The Caribbean's best-kept secret

Tucked into the south-western tip of Dominica lies one of the Caribbean's best-kept secrets. The twin villages of Soufrière and Scott's Head sit at the heart of the **Soufrière–Scott's Head Marine Reserve** — a protected bay born from an ancient submerged volcanic crater, plunging to extraordinary depths along lava chutes that geologists still study today.

Above water, the landscape is lush, dramatic, and deeply alive. Below the surface, the reserve consistently ranks among the top ten dive destinations in the world. The headland at Scott's Head — the Cachacrou Peninsula — separates the calmer Caribbean Sea from the wilder Atlantic, creating a meeting of waters unlike anything else in the region.

These are working villages with real character. Fishermen still haul nets at dawn; locals greet strangers like old friends. Soufrière is small and wonderfully walkable — built on a steep hill down to the ocean, everything is within five to fifteen minutes on foot.



10
TOP-TEN DIVE SITE
WORLDWIDE

365
DAYS A YEAR,
RESIDENT SPERM
WHALES

15min
WALKABLE END TO
END



ACCOMMODATION

From world-class eco-luxury resorts to welcoming community guesthouses, self-catering apartments and simple village rooms — whatever your style or budget, you'll find a home here.



SUSTAINABLE LUXURY BY DESIGN

\$\$\$\$\$ · Luxury

Coulibri Ridge

Perched atop a mountain ridge over Soufrière Bay on a 285-acre estate, Coulibri Ridge is the Caribbean's most celebrated eco-luxury resort and one of the world's finest examples of regenerative hospitality. The 14-suite, fully off-grid property is powered by 300+ solar panels, with rainwater harvesting, chlorine-free pools, and stone hand-chiselled by local craftsmen.

Suites span the Sky Penthouse with private plunge pool, the Morne Fou Loft and the Sea View Studio. On site: two infinity pools, a yoga pavilion, spa, gym, two restaurants (Mesa and Vista), and 200 acres of gardens, orchard and working farm.

[coulibriridge.com](#) +1 (767) 255-9200 [info@coulibriridge.com](#)



ALL-INCLUSIVE ECO-LUXURY RESORT

\$\$\$ · Premium

Jungle Bay Dominica

Set 392 feet above the Caribbean Sea on a 19-acre hillside laced with 100+ varieties of tropical fruit, Jungle Bay feels like the jungle decided to become a hotel. Its 89 rooms pair rustic, artisan-crafted interiors with genuine comfort — air conditioning, rain-drop showers and private balconies.

The all-inclusive wellness programme covers daily breakfast, yoga, and a daily treatment at the 14-room Bamboo Spa. Two pools (including a sea-view infinity pool), two yoga studios, a fitness centre and the Calabash Restaurant round it out. Official partner of Nature Island Dive, with a regular village shuttle. Not staying? Non-guests can buy a Day Pass for the pools and spa, subject to occupancy.

[junglebaydominica.com](#) +1 (767) 235-0025 [info@junglebaydominica.com](#)



NATURE SANCTUARY & COMMUNITY HUB

\$ · Value

Rodney's Wellness Retreat

An unspoiled nature sanctuary in the valleys of Kanawa, and a genuine village institution. A short hike from Segments 1 and 2 of the Waitukubuli National Trail, it's a perfect base for walkers. CarRod's botanical garden invites fruit-picking; the Big Banana Pool offers day-use swimming under the mountains and, at night, a canopy of stars.

The Kanawa Restaurant serves local cuisine by chef Augustine, and the Mayan Bar pours the famous Kanawa rum punch. Full Moon Karaoke, the GrownFolks Party, weddings and group retreats all find a home here.

+1 (767) 723-5417 [relax@rodneyswellness.com](#)



AWARD-WINNING COMMUNITY GUESTHOUSE

\$ · Value

Soufrière Guesthouse

A TripAdvisor Travelers' Choice winner and a favourite among hikers, divers and adventure travellers, set in the idyllic Soufrière Valley a ten-minute walk from the beach. Five private en-suite rooms and two dormitory rooms suit solo backpackers, couples and groups alike.

The ethos is community: a well-equipped communal kitchen, shared lounge and bar, a mountain-view terrace, hammocks, yoga mats and a trapeze, a small library, and fast WiFi throughout. Solar water heaters keep every room in plentiful hot water.

soufriereguesthouse.com +1 (767) 275-5454 info@soufriereguesthouse.com



SELF-CATERING APARTMENTS

\$

Soufrière Guesthouse Apartments

Two two-bedroom apartments just down the road from the main guesthouse — each with a shared bathroom, large kitchen and a balcony over the valley. Ideal for week-plus stays; ten minutes to the bayfront.

+1 (767) 275-5454 info@soufriereguesthouse.com



ARTISAN ECO-ACCOMMODATION

\$\$

EcoLodgic — Upper Love Cottage

A hidden gem recommended by local dive operators, celebrated for its artistic vision and distinctive character. For travellers with a taste for the unique and a love of creative spaces.

Book via Airbnb or local dive operators

HILLTOP B&B WITH VALLEY VIEWS

\$

KDees B&B

A two-bedroom downstairs apartment at the top of the village: fully equipped kitchen, washer/dryer, hot shower, cable TV and strong WiFi. The bayfront is a fifteen-minute walk (and a hill) away — but the peace up here more than compensates.

Karleen · +1 (767) 277-4733

VILLAGE APARTMENT

\$

Joan's House

A pleasant two-bedroom, one-bath apartment with a fully equipped kitchen, comfortable common area and a large outdoor deck — five to eight minutes on foot from the bayfront. Rent one room or both, short or long term — handy for divers on extended stays.

Joan · +1 (767) 612-2369

Guesthouses & Eco-Stays

CONTINUED

CENTRAL VILLAGE APARTMENT

\$

Soufrière Rosa Guesthouse

A colourful pink upstairs apartment in the centre of the village — arguably the most central option of all, a three-minute walk to the Blue Element Freedive Centre and the bayfront. Two bedrooms, a kitchen and a small living space.

+1 (767) 315-8927

COMPACT CENTRAL STUDIO

\$

Mirage Studio 1

A compact studio minutes from the bayfront and bus stop: fridge, kettle, kitchenette, fan, great WiFi, hot-and-cold shower and a mosquito net. An outdoor front patio for fresh air. Perfect for a solo traveller or couple.

Bevan · +1 (767) 261-2400

APARTMENT WITH GARDEN PATIO

\$

Mirage Apartment 2

The larger neighbour to Studio 1: a generous living room with sofas, an open-plan kitchen, and a double bedroom with mosquito net. The stand-out is an outdoor patio overlooking a lush garden — a genuinely lovely place to unwind. Great WiFi.

Bevan · +1 (767) 261-2400

Self-Catering Homes & Apartments

10 STAYS



GROUP HOUSE · SLEEPS 9

\$\$ · \$950/wk · \$2,150/mo

Hill Top House

High on the village hill, catching a year-round easterly breeze. Newly renovated four-bedroom house sleeping nine, with two baths, full kitchen, lounge, outdoor shower, gym, washer and WiFi, plus a long balcony with outstanding mountain views. An ideal base for a group of divers.

WhatsApp +1 (808) 430-7746



NEWLY RENOVATED VILLAGE HOUSE

\$

Lloyd's House

A warm, colourful two-bedroom, one-bath house in the village with a large balcony framing the valley — perfect for morning coffee or an open-air dinner. Spacious living room and a large kitchen with gas stove and air fryer. Fans, linens, WiFi and on-site parking. Lloyd arranges check-in and taxis.

WhatsApp +1 (808) 430-7746



SPACIOUS HILL APARTMENT

\$\$

Soufrière Hill Top Apartment

A generously proportioned apartment on the upper hill: a large lounge, kitchen-diner, master bedroom, spare room and a balcony over the green hillside. Comfortable sofas and a homely feel — there's even a guitar in the corner. Ten minutes down to the bay and the marine reserve.

WhatsApp +1 (808) 430-7746



MODERN VACATION HOME · SLEEPS 7

\$\$

Rosehill Heights

A stylish four-bedroom, two-floor home in Rosehill with combined mountain and sea views from the porch. Locally handmade beds convert to king-sized; a laptop workspace and strong WiFi suit working travellers and groups. Tinted, screened windows and fans keep it cool.

rentalsdom.com +1 (767) 277-0667





APARTMENT FOR GROUPS · SLEEPS 4

\$\$

Rosehill Apartment

The ground-floor neighbour to Rosehill Heights: a cosy two-bedroom, four-bed rental with a minimalist, locally-inspired feel. Four handmade singles convert to two kings — ideal for two couples or four friends. Mountain-view porch and great-value independence.

rentalsdom.com +1 (767) 277-0667



ONE-BEDROOM · SPECTACULAR VIEWS

\$\$

Rainbow Heights

A colourful one-bedroom apartment in Rosehill with panoramic views that justify the uphill walk. Living room and kitchen below with a narrow verandah; bedroom and bath above with its own quaint verandah and incredible vistas. On-site parking; five minutes to the village.

rentalsdom.com +1 (767) 277-0667



FAMILY HOME IN THE VILLAGE

\$\$

Verna's Corner

A refurbished family home in the Canal district — the vibrant heart of Soufrière, right by the main bus stop. Spacious living/dining/kitchen with fans, cable TV and WiFi; a master en-suite plus a twin and a single sharing a bath. Restaurants, beach and shops all on the doorstep.

rentalsdom.com +1 (767) 277-0667



HILLSIDE HOUSE · SEA-VIEW BALCONY

\$\$

Brinda's House

A bright, freshly finished house on the hill above the village, with a covered balcony that looks straight down the bay to the church, the bayfront and the Scott's Head headland. Open-plan living and dining, a full kitchen with breakfast bar and gas stove, and large tiled bedrooms with en-suite bathrooms opening onto the balcony. Fans throughout; minutes on foot to the bayfront and the Blue Element platform.

Book via Blue Element blueelementfreediving@gmail.com

NEWLY BUILT VALLEY RETREAT

\$

Spring Valley Cottage

A newly built, high-standard cottage in the Soufrière Valley, surrounded by banana, plantain and papaya. Combined kitchen-lounge at the entrance, bedroom and bath at the rear, and a balcony over the garden. A twenty-minute walk from the village; washing machine on site.

Julee · +1 (767) 317-9974

TWO-BED · AIR CONDITIONED

\$\$

Angol Residence

A well-equipped two-bedroom apartment in a quiet hillside spot, fifteen minutes from the bay. Stocked kitchen, hot shower, washing machine, and air conditioning in both bedrooms — a rarity in the village. Streaming-ready TV and a valley-view balcony. Pay-as-you-go electricity; water and internet included.

Audrey · +1 (845) 559-7776

DINING & REFRESHMENTS

Dominican cuisine is rooted in Creole technique — local produce flavoured by the island's spices, drawing on Kalinago, African, French and English traditions. Most produce comes from the surrounding hills and the sea outside your door.

\$ A NOTE ON CASH

Most local eateries and bars in Soufrière and Scott's Head are cash only. The nearest ATMs are in Roseau, roughly 20–25 minutes away — bring local XCD or small US dollar notes for everyday eating and drinking.



FRESH SEAFOOD WITH A VIEW · SCOTT'S HEAD

Cash & card

Chez Wen Cuisine

A prime position in Scott's Head, with outdoor seating directly over Soufrière Bay. The menu centres on locally-caught lobster, crayfish and octopus, prepared with the rich, fragrant flavours of Dominican Creole cooking. A destination in its own right.

chezwenrestaurant.com



RESORT DINING · JUNGLE BAY

Calabash Restaurant

High on the hillside with sweeping ocean views, blending Caribbean, Cajun-Creole and American traditions. A celebrated buffet breakfast of local organic produce; dinner is an event. Vegetarian, vegan and dairy-free options. Open to guests and, subject to availability, outside visitors.

HOME-COOKED · SOUFRIÈRE

Cash only

Teacher's Place

The authentic local favourite: honest, home-cooked Dominican food in a no-frills village setting. Hearty plates of local provisions, freshly cooked fish, stewed chicken and traditional sides. A genuine slice of village life that keeps travellers coming back.

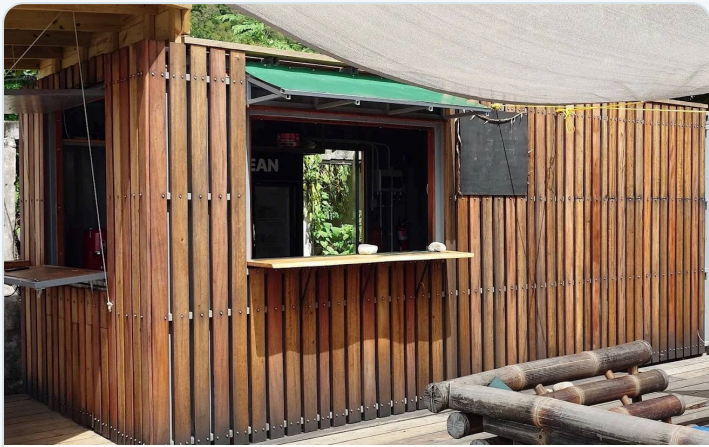


CAFÉ · NATURE ISLAND DIVE

Bottom Time Café

Fresh-ground local coffee, cappuccino, espresso, cold brew and fruit smoothies from Bernisa. The lionfish sandwich — made from the invasive species the dive shop culls from the reef — has become a village institution. Black-bean veggie burgers too.

Village Eateries & Bars



BAYFRONT · BLUE ELEMENT Cash only

Nourish Café

The Blue Element Freedive Centre serves daily smoothies and light snacks from its bayfront café — a convenient, healthy stop before or after time in the water.



VILLAGE GRILL · SOUFRIÈRE Cash only

Weefies Bar & Grill

A popular local bar and grill in the village, open for dinner. Straightforward, tasty grilled food in an easy-going village atmosphere.



VILLAGE GRILL · SOUFRIÈRE Cash only

Hazel's Touch

Another reliable local grill, open for evening meals. Good honest Dominican cooking at excellent prices.



SATURDAY BREAKFAST · SOUFRIÈRE Cash only

Joan's Snackette

On Saturday mornings, the only place to be. Locals and visitors gather for traditional Dominican breakfast fare — bakes, cocoa tea, accra (saltfish fritters) and more. Arrive hungry and early.



BEACH BAR · HOT SPRINGS Cash only

Bubbles Beach Bar

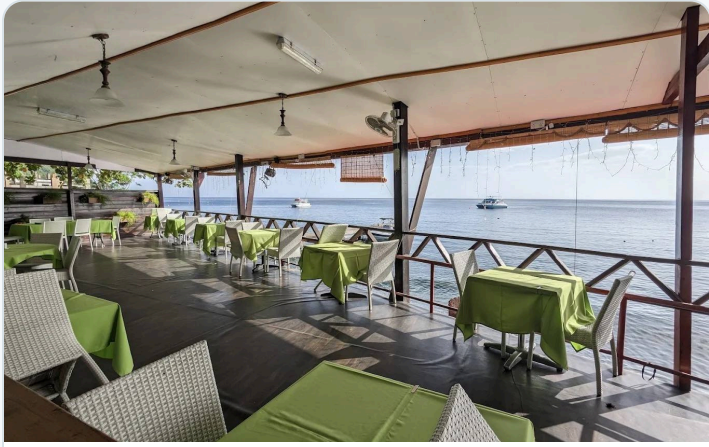
At Bubble Beach Spa, a snackette and bar serves rum punches and refreshments — so you can combine a soak in the volcanic baths with a sundowner as the sun drops behind Scott's Head.



LOCAL CUISINE · RODNEY'S

Kanawa Restaurant & Mayan Bar

Chef Augustine prepares tasty local Dominican cuisine within Rodney's Wellness Retreat in the Kanawa Valley, and the Mayan Bar's signature Kanawa rum punch has its own word-of-mouth reputation. A wonderful spot surrounded by botanical gardens.



CARIBBEAN DINING · 15-MIN DRIVE

Ocean's Edge Restaurant

A well-regarded option a short drive up the coast, offering a step up in formality with Caribbean cuisine and sea views.

STRAIGHT FROM THE SOURCE

Fresh Fish & Village Snacks

Buy fresh fish directly from the fishermen at the Soufrière waterfront — an experience in itself. Throughout the village, saltfish and bakes are sold as street snacks all day (bakes are a local fried bread, stuffed with various fillings, and make excellent fast food). A small convenience store covers basics and drinks; groceries and fresh produce are best bought in Roseau, which has a full range of supermarkets.



— IN & OUT OF THE WATER · 03

RECREATION & ACTIVITIES

A protected bay formed from a volcanic crater, a long-distance trail that begins at the headland, and year-round sperm whales offshore. There is far more to do here than fit into one visit.

Scuba Diving

The reserve consistently ranks among the top ten dive destinations on the planet. Born from a submerged volcanic crater, the marine environment has a unique thermal character — warm-water upwellings, hydrothermal vents, and dramatic topography of sheer walls, swim-throughs and soaring pinnacles. Green and hawksbill turtles, seahorses, frogfish, batfish and banded coral shrimp all call it home.

Nature Island Dive is the premier operator in Soufrière, working in small groups with a concierge approach — PADI/SSI certification, advanced and speciality courses, lionfish culling, reef surveys, coral restoration and a junior Scuba Club.

natureislanddive.dm

KEY DIVE SITES

- **Scott's Head Pinnacles** — coral-encrusted slopes from 35 ft to a 120-ft wall, with exceptional visibility.
- **L'Abym (The Abyss)** — a dramatic vertical wall descending into the crater, with pelagics.
- **Crater's Edge** — one of the most atmospheric sites, tracing the rim of the submerged caldera.
- **Champagne Reef** — geothermal bubbles rise from the seafloor for a surreal, effervescent dive.
- **Dangleben's Pinnacles** — coral-covered spires alive with reef fish and invertebrates.

Freediving

A dedicated freediving centre on the bayfront — one of very few specialist freediving schools in the Caribbean. Courses run from beginner to advanced, alongside guided experiences in the reserve. The bay's clear water and calm conditions make it an ideal environment for breath-hold diving — and the reason many visitors find their way to Soufrière in the first place.

Book a platform session or course: blueelementstore.com

Snorkelling

The recreation zone at Tout Sable Beach is set aside for shore-based snorkelling and swimming. The Caribbean side of Scott's Head Point offers some of the best shallow-reef snorkelling on the island — a short walk along the headland leads to clear water, healthy coral and abundant fish. Equipment hire is available locally; SSMR user fees apply and go directly back into the reserve.



Hiking & Walking Trails

- **Waitukubuli National Trail — Segment 1.** The Caribbean's only long-distance trail begins at Scott's Head Point, climbing Morne Crabier and dropping into the Sulphur Springs valley — a demanding full-day hike through extraordinary scenery.
- **Scott's Head Point.** An easy walk to the summit of the Cachacrou Peninsula, where a cannon marks an 18th-century fort. On a clear day, views reach north along the leeward coast and south to Martinique.
- **Galion Viewpoint.** A short but steep hike up to the hilltop village of Galion, rewarding climbers with sweeping views across Soufrière Bay.
- **Soufrière Valley Trails.** Quiet roads and paths winding past sulphur springs, fruit trees and village life — perfect for a morning walk.



SOUFRIÈRE OUTDOOR CENTRE

Sea Kayaking & Paddleboarding

Dominica's premier ecotourism operation for sea kayaking and snorkelling tours, on the waterfront with direct access to the reserve. Guided paddles cross the bay, trace the coastline and reach Scott's Head Point — one of the Caribbean's most spectacular routes. Lessons from beginner to intermediate, kayak and paddleboard hire, and the originators of the Waitukubuli Sea Trail for multi-day trips up the coast. Also the official outfitter for the start of Segment 1 of the National Trail.

soc-dom.com soufriereoutdoorcentre@gmail.com

Photo: Soufrière Outdoor Centre

VOLCANIC SEASIDE OASIS

Bubble Beach Spa

In front of the Soufrière Church, "Mr. Bubble" — Dale Mitchell — has enclosed underwater fumaroles into shallow mineral pools right on the beach, warmed by the volcano below. Mineral-rich and widely believed to be therapeutic. Changing rooms, a snackette and beach chairs; no entrance fee, donations welcome.

POOLS, SPA & LUNCH UP THE HILL

Jungle Bay Day Pass

Not staying at Jungle Bay? Non-guests can buy a Day Pass for the resort's two pools — including the sea-view infinity pool — with treatments at the Bamboo Spa and lunch at the Calabash Restaurant bookable alongside. Availability depends on hotel occupancy on the day, so book ahead. The village shuttle runs regularly from the bayfront.

guestservices@junglebaydominica.com WhatsApp +1 (767) 275-1834

STROKE ACROSS THE BAY

Open Water Swimming

Soufrière Bay's calm, clear water makes it exceptional for open water swimming. Local guide Weston Moses offers tailored swims for all levels in one of the Caribbean's most beautiful natural settings.

westonmoses@gmail.com

VOLCANIC WELLNESS

Sulphur Springs & Mineral Baths

The Soufrière Valley sits atop one of Dominica's most geologically active zones. Several sulphur springs and hot mineral baths are reachable on foot or by short drive — mineral-rich, believed to be therapeutic, and a quintessentially Dominican experience.

YEAR-ROUND SPERM WHALES

Whale & Dolphin Watching

Dominica is the only country in the world where sperm whales reside year-round, and the deep volcanic water off Scott's Head is prime territory. Several operators run excursions from the reserve, with spinner and bottlenose dolphins and seasonal humpbacks regularly sighted.

THE CARIBBEAN'S LONGEST-RUNNING FESTIVAL

Scott's Head DiveFest

Held annually in Scott's Head, DiveFest is the Caribbean's longest-running diving festival — a celebration of the reserve that draws divers, freedivers and ocean lovers from across the region for freediving competitions, scuba challenges, food, music and community festivities.

MEET YOUR FOOD AT THE SOURCE

Farm Tours

Local farmer Joe offers guided farm tours from Soufrière — an eye-opening introduction to Dominica's sustainable, organic agriculture. Discover how local provisions, tropical fruits and herbs are grown and harvested. An ideal complement to any meal in the village.

PRACTICAL INFORMATION

Getting There

Douglas Charles International Airport is about 1 hr 30 min from Soufrière. Airport taxis run around US\$100 per person one-way (US\$80 for groups of two or more); your driver will stop in Roseau for groceries or an ATM. Car rentals are available at the airport or in Roseau.

From the Roseau Ferry Terminal, taxis and local buses reach Soufrière in about 25 minutes to the south — the local bus costs around US\$3. Canefield Airport, the domestic/regional airport near Roseau, is roughly 35–40 minutes from the village.

Weather

Sunny, hot days year-round, cooled by an easterly Atlantic breeze. Tropical showers can arrive any time — it's the Nature Island, and the rain is part of what keeps it so lush.

DEC–APR · DRY	Air 80–85°F · Sea 82–85°F
MAY–NOV · WET	Air 87–90°F · Sea 85–87°F

Most stays have no AC, but natural ventilation, fans and sea breezes keep things comfortable. Windy.com is reliable for conditions.

Cash & Payments

Most shops, restaurants and facilities in Soufrière Village are cash only. Major hotels and finer establishments take cards, but the village runs largely on cash.

The currency is the Eastern Caribbean Dollar (XCD); small US dollar notes are widely accepted. All ATMs are in Roseau (about 20–25 minutes away), with one more at the airport.

Electricity & WiFi

Dominica runs on 220 volts with Type G plugs (the same as the UK). Most phones and laptops handle dual voltage — check other appliances before travelling. Type G adapters are easy to buy around the island, and high-speed, reliable WiFi is available at all listed accommodations.

Packing Tips

Sun protection is essential — sunglasses, a hat, neck buffs, lightweight quick-dry long sleeves and SPF 50+. Bring good insect repellent (though there are fewer biting midges here than on many islands), rehydration tablets and snacks for active days, and shoes for the valley trails. Tap water is safe to drink; bottled is widely available too.



ONE BAY. ONE BREATH. ONE BLUE.

Soufrière & Scott's Head — where the volcano meets the sea, and Dominica is at its most itself.

Book a platform session or course:
blueelementstore.com



BLUE ELEMENT FREEDIVING · SOUFRIÈRE BAY, DOMINICA